

LIGHT



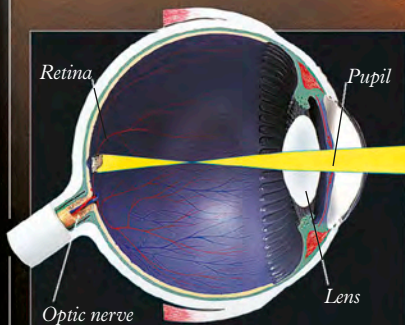
You may need to wear sunglasses on a sunny day, because the bright light hurts your eyes. It is dangerous to look straight

at the sun. The sun's light is not just blinding, it also travels to us very fast.

In just one second, light travels 186,000 miles (300,000 kilometers).

If a straight beam of light has to pass through obstacles such as convex and concave lenses, it changes direction.

This is called refraction.



How we see light

Light enters your eye through your pupil. It passes through a lens, which focuses the object you are looking at onto the retina. Millions of tiny cells inside the retina turn this upside-down image into electrical messages. The optic nerve carries these messages to your brain, which "sees" the image the right way up.

Hot stuff

Most light comes from hot objects. A very hot object makes a very bright light. The sun is white hot, and sunlight is the brightest natural light we have.



Concave lenses curve inward in the middle.

This beam of light comes from a flashlight. A flashlight is a man-made light source.

Light bends outward when it passes through a concave lens.

Convex lenses bulge in the middle.

Light for life

Plants always grow toward the light, even if, like this plant, they have to grow around corners to reach it! Light is very important for life. Plants need light to grow, and we need to eat plants, or animals that eat plants, to stay alive.

